

Beyond Views

What makes users stop scrolling - and what should a product team optimize?

Executive takeaway

Raw watch seconds can reward duration rather than genuine interest. This analysis of **30,000 synthetic viewing events** combines normalized watch time, completion, explicit actions, session continuation, and negative feedback to propose a more defensible ranking experiment.

30K

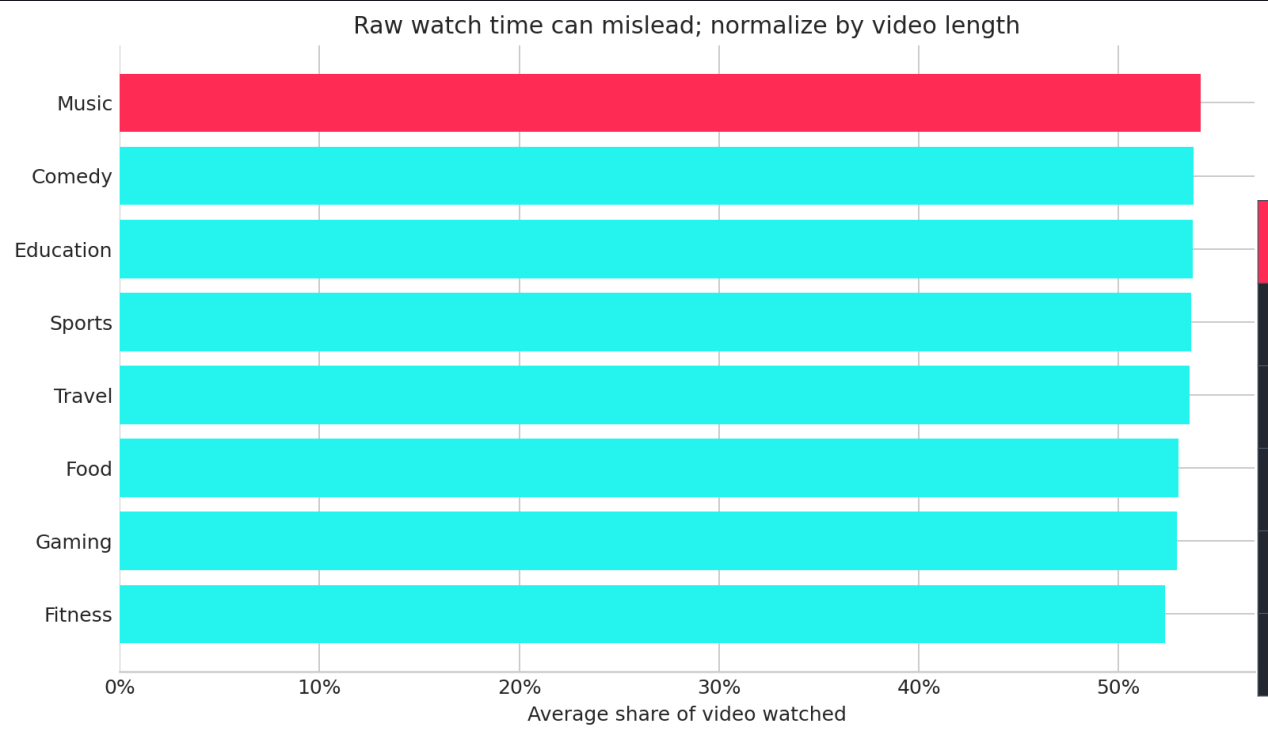
synthetic viewing events

Recommendation

Test a multi-signal ranking score; protect user satisfaction and content diversity with explicit guardrails.

Attention needs context

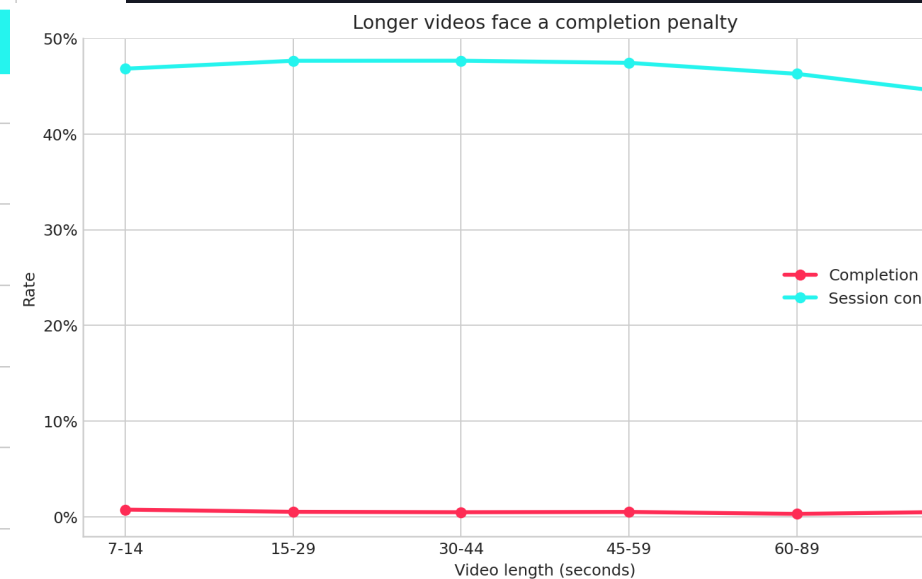
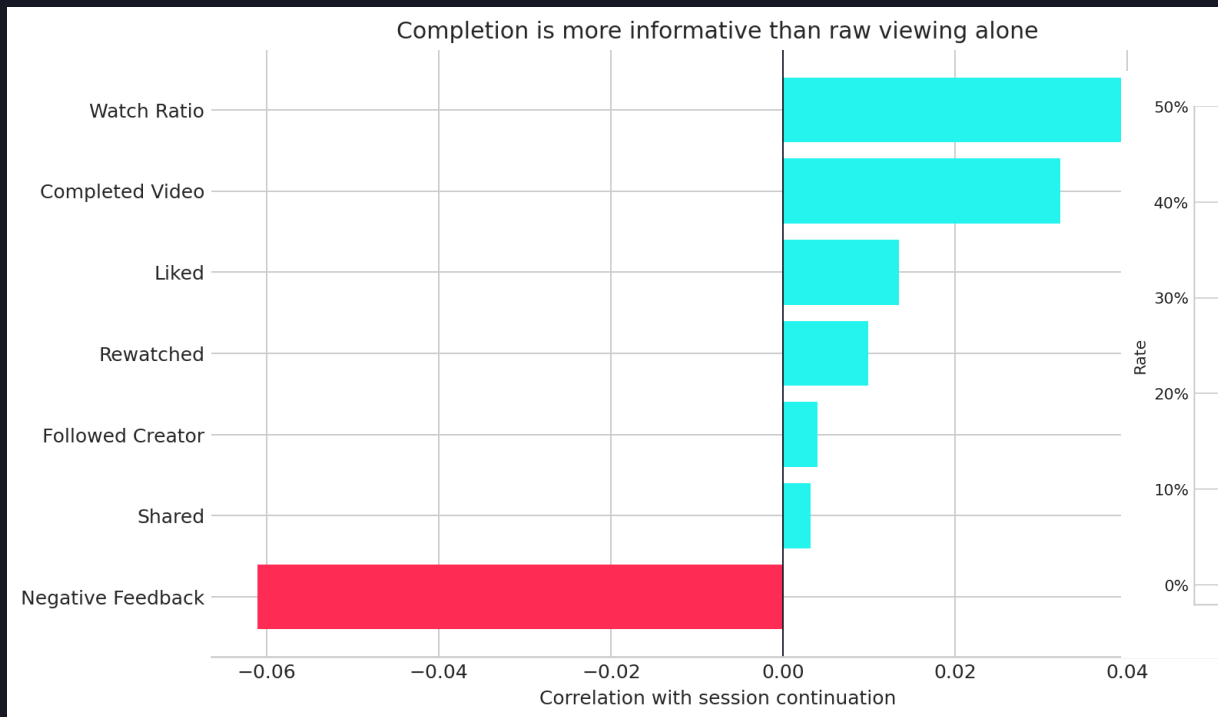
Normalize for duration and separate passive viewing from high-intent actions



Signal	Interpretation
Watch ratio	Attention normalized by length
Completion	Reached at least 95%
Share / follow	Higher-intent value
Quick swipe	Immediate rejection
Negative feedback	Explicit dissatisfaction

Signals tell different stories

Use the pattern to form hypotheses - not causal conclusions



Proposed ranking experiment

Move from an observational insight to a falsifiable product test

CONTROL

Predicted watch time-led ranking

TREATMENT

Multi-signal score: normalized viewing + intent - negative signals

PRIMARY

Meaningful-view rate; session continuation

GUARDRAILS

Negative feedback; content diversity; creator concentration; extreme session length

Decision rule

Ship only if primary metrics improve without a statistically or practically meaningful guardrail deterioration.

What I would do next

A practical roadmap for product, data science, and engineering

1

Calibrate comparisons

Benchmark content within similar length and category contexts.

2

Value intent, not only attention

Add shares, follows, quick swipes, and negative feedback to evaluation.

3

Preserve exploration

Maintain category diversity while confidence in user preferences develops.

4

Validate causally

Run the online experiment and inspect heterogeneous effects for new users.

Limits

Synthetic data demonstrates analytical workflow, not real platform performance. Observational associations can be confounded. Production evaluation should address novelty, seasonality, network effects, safety, and creator fairness.